

The Digital World

A Round-up Of Technology News From Across The Globe

UNITED STATES

Border agents using gamma-imaging technology on an incoming freight train apprehended two men trying to enter the US illegally from Canada. Nilson Giusti, 41, and Agiles Bezerra, 23, were found in two separate cars on the Black Rock Rail Bridge May 14. Inspectors use gamma radiation technology to scan rail cars, trucks and cargo containers for people, weapons and other contraband.

UNITED KINGDOM

Four British members of the global 'DrinkorDie network', an underground software piracy ring, were sentenced May 6 at London's Central Criminal Court. The men had formed part of a gang that communicated across continents via a sophisticated online network, which was also used to distribute pirated copies of software packages.

RUSSIA

Russian oligarchs are turning their attention to the high-technology sector. As indicators, Russian software exports will top \$1 billion this year; SRISA, a pilot IC sub-micron production facility, has put 0.21-micron processing into experimental production; and the two leading Russian chipmakers, Angstrom and Mikron, are expanding their production capacity.

BANGLADESH

A new computer game brought out by Sony and developed by Zipper Interactive, which portrays Bangladesh as a terrorist state, has led to widespread resentment in the country. The mission of the game is to "protect America from enemy forces ... throughout the world," and the main locales for the game are said to be Morocco, Poland and Bangladesh.

SWEDEN

People who use mobile phones in rural areas are three times more likely than city dwellers to suffer from brain tumours, a study has found. Professor Lennart Hardell, a cancer specialist at the University Hospital of Orebro in Sweden, said the results definitely point to a link between the dose of microwave radiation and the risk of developing brain tumours.

AUSTRALIA

The country should beef up competition in the telco market or risk falling behind the world, an international telco expert has said. Ewan Sutherland, head of the international telecommunications users group, said Australia ranks poorly among other OECD (Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development) countries in terms of technology, particularly broadband Internet services.

TALK THE TALK

Cisco And IBM To Launch Speech-Enabled Solutions

IBM and Cisco plan to deliver to contact centres speech-enabled self-service solutions that combine IBM's WebSphere Voice Server product and Cisco's Customer Voice Portal.

The solutions would combine IBM's integration and application infrastructure software and speech technology with Cisco's Internet Protocol (IP) communications and focus on self-service speech applications, which together can enable easier deployment of customised speech applications that enhance the customer experience.

The IBM/Cisco offerings will be designed to let businesses extend enterprise-class speech self-service to remote locations across both IP and non-IP networks—including local and branch offices. When banking customers make after-hours calls to their local branch, they won't be limited to voicemail, or be asked to call another phone number. The Cisco and IBM solutions can allow customers to use speech to interact with centralised automated applications that reflect up-to-date transactions and past history.



Three Incredibly Useful Sites

Files, Freebies, Answers

www.softpedia.com



SOFTPEDIA

A deft download site with scores of free software. The site claims to be the encyclopedia of free software categories such as Science and CAD to the usual games, system, media routine. The neatly arranged interface is user-friendly with no download more than a couple of clicks away. The site also has links to the latest news from the software and media world.

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What do you do when a program fails to load because of a missing .dll file? Go to www.dll-files.com. This site is your one-stop shop for such problems with over 400 common .dll files available for free download. So the next time your PC shows a ".dll file missing" message, don't wring your hands in despair.

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If you have the questions, these guys will give you the answers. That's right. Detailed answers culled from over a hundred online encyclopedias and not just links to those answers. www.answers.com has a search engine-like interface and throws up very comprehensive results for your queries.